

Mandate of Three - current design decisions

Design note. This records the direction following discussion of world structure, bosses, dungeons, parties, classes and QoL. It is not final balance or a complete specification.

1. One logical world

Avoid traditional Metin servers that split the community and manually selectable CH1/CH2/CH3 channels. Mandate should have one logical world and one community. Initially, each open-world zone may exist as a single instance.

If population eventually becomes too high, the backend can create transparent overflow layers. Players do not select layers manually; layering is not for hopping between respawns, and parties/friends may have affinity to the same layer.

Automatic layering is not implemented at this stage, but architecture should not assume a zone always has exactly one instance.

2. Open-world Metins and bosses

Avoid the loop: fixed point -> respawn every 30 minutes -> players follow a spawn route -> repeat. Prefer spawn regions: Metins, elite packs and bosses can appear at different points within a region rather than one fixed location.

Player activity can build regional pressure. Normal grinding can lead to elite packs, then Metins/minibosses, a larger event and a regional boss. Players should trigger content through normal play rather than waiting for a timer.

3. Bosses

Bosses should be substantially more meaningful encounters than in classic Metin. A strong polymorphed player should not erase a boss in 5-15 seconds.

An open-world boss should survive long enough to make the encounter noticeable, have a few simple mechanics and encourage spontaneous cooperation. Preferred mechanics: cleave/frontal, AoE, adds, a simple phase change, repositioning, a vulnerability window or an object to destroy. Avoid raid bosses requiring memorization of a dozen mechanics.

4. Dungeons and tiers

Base dungeon versions should have no entry cost. Higher tiers may require a key, sigil or similar item obtainable in the open world, among other sources. Higher tiers should primarily offer more materials per hour, a greater chance of good drops and potentially additional modifiers.

Higher tiers should not be the sole source of basic progression materials. Casual players still progress through open world/free dungeons; hardcore players improve efficiency through harder tiers. Keys may be tradable, allowing open-world farmers and dungeon farmers to have different economic roles.

5. Party design

Mandate should be more party-friendly than Metin 2 without requiring parties. Preferred model: solo is fully viable; 2-3 players form a highly efficient sweet spot; 4-5 tackle harder dungeons/bosses; larger groups do open-world events/regional bosses.

Normal grinding, quests and basic progression should be possible solo. Parties increase options, efficiency and class synergies and unlock harder content without requiring a rigid tank + healer + DPS model.

6. Classes and self-buffs

Every class should be a viable main able to farm a spot independently. Avoid a main plus second-client Shaman required for buffs.

Each class should have its own skill/aura/stance supporting its basic combat loop, not identical +X% attack for everyone:

- Warrior: heavy attacks, cleave, poise, armor penetration/knockback.
- Ninja: attack speed, crit, multihit, bleed/mobility.
- Sura: enchanted weapon, magic on-hit, sustain, debuffs.
- Shaman: elemental/spirit imbue, splash, attack speed, support utility.

7. Self auras versus party buffs

Class-defining self-buffs should generally be toggles/stances rather than short timed buffs. Players should not need to recast a basic class-function buff every few minutes.

Party buffs can last approximately 30-60 minutes and be weaker than the skill owner's version. Support should help the party without being penalized for solo play.

8. Potions and basic consumables

Avoid the traditional buy 500 red potions -> farm -> return to buy more loop. Basic sustain should not be a logistical tax on playing.

Preferred basic HP potion: infinite uses -> strong regeneration for around eight seconds -> approximately 20-second cooldown. Exact values are balance placeholders. The potion should not have 100% uptime: autopotion still has a role, defense/sustain builds matter and harder pulls can overcome sustain. Autopotion should be normal game QoL, not premium functionality.

9. Lure / capes

If gathering mob groups is part of basic combat, lure should not be consumable. Preferred model: Lure/Taunt tool -> infinite uses -> cooldown -> attracts/aggro mobs within a radius. It can be a skill, tool or classic cape equivalent without consumable stacks.

10. Meaningful consumables

Limited resources can remain where they create real decisions: strong emergency heals, boss elixirs, resistance consumables, revive items, special dungeon utility, food and temporary power buffs. Basic combat should work without continuous consumable purchases.

Overall direction

Keep grinding, farming spots, mob groups, +0...+9, Metins, bosses, trade, a shared world and simple readable combat.

Remove channel hopping, exact spawn-timer farming, required buff alts, consumable tax, premium QoL, dungeons as the only worthwhile activity and bosses dying before they can act.

A Metin-like MMO retaining its simplicity and social grind while modernizing encounter design, classes, progression and QoL.